



sides agreed a truce, whereby the **Goths** were **allowed to settle** in the empire in return for providing troops for the Roman army.

The **Gupta Empire** continued to **expand** under Chandragupta II (r. 375–415) in northern India. He fought against the Sakas, annexing much of northwestern India. He also made an **astute marriage alliance** that extended his realm to the southwest.



Iron pillar of Delhi

This iron pillar at Qutb complex on the outskirts of Delhi is said to have been erected on the orders of Chandragupta II.



St. Jerome (c. 347–420) completed the *Vulgate*, the first definitive translation of the Bible into Latin, c. 405.

IN CENTRAL AMERICA, THE MAYAN CITY OF TIKAL had reached the peak of its influence in the late 4th century. In 378, a foreign lord called **Siyaj Kak** arrived in the city, possibly from Teotihuacán. His arrival, which may represent a military conquest, led to the **death of Tikal's ruler** Chak Tok Ich'aak and the **destruction of most of Tikal's public monuments**. Siyaj Kak installed a new dynasty on the throne of Tikal, possibly drawn from the ruling house of Teotihuacán, with **Yax Nuun Ayiin** ("Curl Snout"; r. 379–404) as the first ruler. Monuments depict him in northern Mexican, rather than Mayan, dress. Under his rule, Tikal's direct influence extended some 30 miles (50 km) away.

In the Western Roman Empire, **Gratian** had spent much of his time since the Battle of Adrianople (378) in northern Italy, where he **continued to act against pagans** in Rome, ordering the removal of the Altar of Victory from the Senate House in 382. In 383, he led an army north to face an invasion of Gaul by the Alemanni, but was then faced with a **revolt in Britain**, where the legions declared their commander **Magnus Maximus emperor**. Many of Gratian's commanders defected and in August 383 he was captured and executed by Maximus, who had crossed over to Gaul. **Theodosius**, fearful of trouble with Persia or a Gothic revolt in the Balkans if he moved west, **recognized Maximus** as his colleague. A peace with Persia in 386, however,



St. Ambrose

A Roman nobleman by birth, Ambrose was Bishop of Milan from 374 to 397. He exercised a powerful influence over Theodosius I.

freed Theodosius to react when Maximus invaded Italy in 387. In August 388, he marched swiftly into northern Italy, **capturing Maximus** near Aquileia and having him executed.

As well as campaigning against the Goths and Maximus, Theodosius was preoccupied with the **imposition of Orthodox Christianity**. He moved against the Arians, deposing the Bishop of Constantinople in 380 and calling a council in 381 in the capital, which reaffirmed the anti-Arian decisions of the Council of Nicaea (see 325). He connived in the **destruction of many pagan temples**, including the great temple of Serapis in Alexandria, and in 391 he **forbade all pagan sacrifices** throughout the empire.

“THE THICKER THE HAY, THE EASIER IT IS MOWED.”

Alaric the Goth, speaking of his enemies c. 400

IN 392, VALENTINIAN II, WHO HAD CONTINUED TO RULE OVER ITALY, was found hanged. His military commander Arbogast—suspected by some of Valentinian's murder—promptly made **Flavius Eugenius**, a middle-ranking official, emperor. Theodosius refused to recognize Eugenius, and in 393 he **invaded Italy**. To gain support in the Senate—where paganism was still strong—the Christian Eugenius **revoked** all of Theodosius's **anti-pagan laws**. But, in August 394, he was defeated by the Theodosian army at the **Frigidus River** near Aquileia. Theodosius did not enjoy his rule as sole emperor long, dying in January 395. The empire was then divided between his two sons: the older, Arcadius, taking the eastern part and his younger brother, Honorius, taking the

western one. Although there was no clear intention to do so, this split marked a permanent division; after 395 no one emperor ruled the whole empire again.

The Goths had taken part on Theodosius's side at the Battle of the Frigidus River and felt they had not been sufficiently rewarded for their losses. In 395, they rose up, led by **Alaric** (r. 395–410). Despite an attempt by **Stilicho** (c. 365–408), the half-Vandal commander of the Western Roman army, to suppress them, the Goths escaped and marauded throughout Greece in 396. Stilicho moved against Alaric again in 397, but once more failed to defeat him. A **brief halt to the Gothic rampage** came after Alaric's appointment by the Eastern Roman government to *magister militum* (a senior general).



Divided in two

The split of the Roman Empire into Eastern and Western divisions in 395 was permanent. By 476, its Western part would be overrun by barbarians.

KEY

Eastern Roman Empire
Western Roman Empire

379 Theodosius appointed Eastern Emperor by Western Emperor Gratian

379 Shapur II dies

381 Second Council of Constantinople condemns Arianism

383 Theodosius signs peace with Goths: gives them land in exchange for military service

383 Magnus Maximus proclaimed emperor by legions in Britain (to 388)

384 Buddhism arrives in Korea

386 The Toba Wei reunify northern China, ruling as the Northern Wei dynasty

385 Copper mining and smelting begins at Kansanshi on Congo-Zambia border

390 Theodosius forced to perform public penance after massacre in an uprising in Thessalonica

388 Chandragupta II conducts war against the Shakas

391 Theodosius makes Christianity official religion of the empire

392 Emperor Valentinian II dies (b. 371)

394 Theodosius defeats and kills Eugenius, becoming sole emperor

393 The Yamato of Japan overrun Silla and Paekche, Korea

395 Theodosius dies; the empire is divided in two

396 The half-Vandal general Stilicho becomes effective ruler of the Western Empire

397 Gildo begins major rebellion against Roman emperor Honorius in North Africa

399 Yazdegerd becomes Persian ruler

c. 400 Intensive period of building at Teotihuacán

400 Revolt of the Goths under Ganaas: gains power, but he is soon expelled and killed by the Huns